

DELHI | Uniform Order

Soldiers have always been known for proudly displaying their ribbons and medals on their uniforms, but the Indian Army's recent directive to its troops ends all that.

In keeping with international norms of plain combat uniforms, personnel have been instructed not to wear bright, medals or decorations on their combat uniforms, giving them a stripped-down but more menacing combat appearance. Only name tags and rank and regiment markers will be worn in muted black instead of gold



A BRIGADIER IN THE NEW MUTED UNIFORM

piping. Medals and ribbons, however, will continue to be worn with the regular olive green uniforms. "It is a welcome move because the camouflage uniforms had ceased becoming so," says a senior army officer.

by Sandeep Unnithan

MUMBAI | Aid Overhaul

Maharashtra's long-awaited ambulance project will finally take off. The state Cabinet has given the green light to the scheme, which intended to have ambu-

lances arrive in emergency situations within 20 minutes. The ambulance service was meant to have a call centre, GPS units and a wireless network in Maharashtra like in Goa, Gujarat and Karnataka. The execution of the project, to be carried out by Satyam in 2007, was stalled due to the company's financial scandal. Now the state will call for a tender again. The project will be started in six districts in the initial phase and will later be rolled out to other areas.

by Mitali Patel

AMBULANCES IN THE STATE WILL SOON GO HI-TECH



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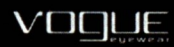


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